

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Atya Sherwani

Address: 65 York Road Cheam SM2 6HN

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing as a local resident of more than twenty years to express my enthusiastic support for the proposed redevelopment of the former ambulance station on Dorset Road. I live at York Road, SM2 6HN, and having walked past this site for years, I firmly believe that the current plans represent a thoughtful and high-quality use for a piece of land that has sat vacant for far too long. From the perspective of an immediate neighbour, the design appears remarkably sensitive to the established character of Belmont. The architectural approach does not just fill a gap; it enhances the street scene by replacing a redundant, utilitarian structure with a building that feels proportionate in scale and sympathetic to the surrounding residential aesthetic.

The environmental considerations within the application are particularly impressive and form a major part of my support. The integration of enhanced greenery and the protection of ecological value on-site will provide a much-needed visual lift to this corner of the neighbourhood. Rather than a harsh, paved-over footprint, the proposal introduces soft landscaping that will help the site blend naturally with the verdant quality of our local roads. This focus on biodiversity and high-quality outdoor space shows a commitment to creating a sustainable environment that benefits the wider community, not just the eventual users of the building.

The social infrastructure and community need addressed by this application cannot be overstated. There is a clear and pressing requirement for modern, accessible facilities in Sutton that cater to inclusive local provision, and this site is perfectly situated to meet those needs. The accessibility features built into the design ensure that the facility will be welcoming and usable for all members of the public, which is a significant material planning benefit. It is heartening to see a proposal that prioritises social value while remaining entirely compatible with the residential context of the area,

working with the grain of the neighbourhood rather than against it.

When looking at the overall planning balance, the benefits of this scheme far outweigh any minor changes to the local setting. The anticipated activity levels appear realistic for a site of this nature and compatible with our quiet residential life. By bringing a derelict site back into a meaningful, community-focused use, the borough is securing a facility that will serve Belmont for generations. The project is a well-rounded and sustainable piece of urban planning that respects the privacy and amenity of neighbours while delivering a vital public asset. I fully support this application and hope to see it approved.